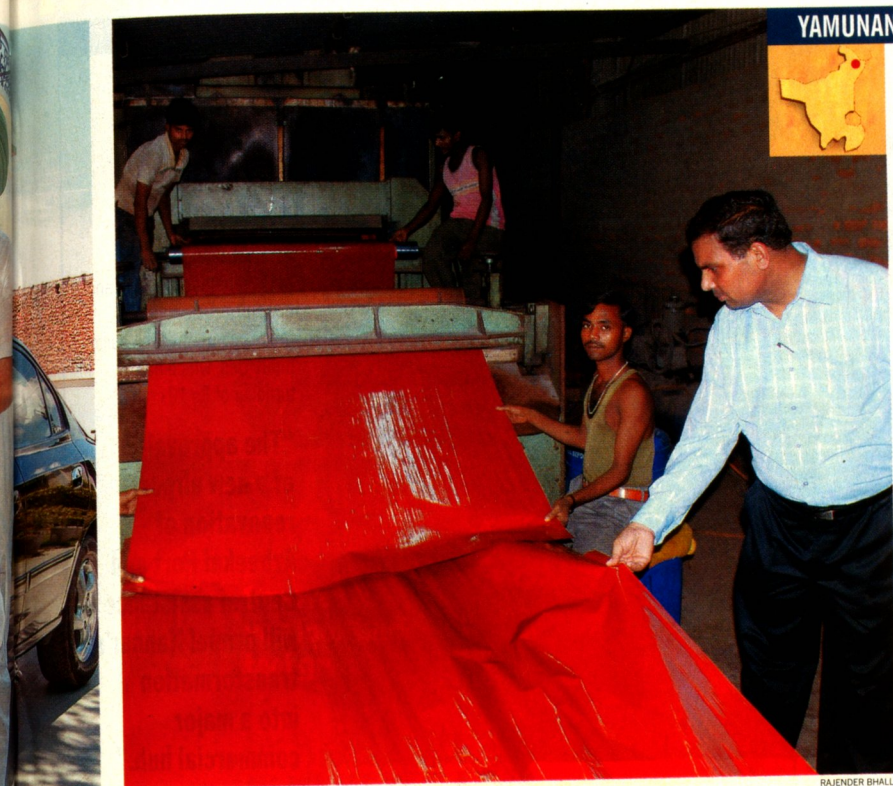




YAMUNANAGAR

HARYANA



Growth engine:
Sugar mills, plywood,
metal & heavy
machinery industry

Town population:
2,50,000

J.K. Bihani, 48, is MD of Galaxy Plywood Industries, with a turnover of Rs 10 crore. Believes town will become a commercial hub.

"Yamunanagar has already emerged as an industrial hub, and the new townships and educational institutions coming up will add to the economic velocity."

RAJENDER BHALLA



ERODE

TAMIL NADU



Growth engine:
Turmeric, textiles,
plastic, auto parts

Town population:
2,00,000

S. Sivananthan, 60, is managing partner of Fashion Field which employs over 300 people and delivers annual sales of Rs 8 crore.

"The boom in Erode is reflected in the rush of retailers like Spencers and Reliance, and in realty prices that are touching Rs 6,000 per sq ft."

of raw materials needed for the Indian textile market flow through Erode," says S. Sivananthan, secretary, Erode Textile and Garments Exporters' Association. Plastics and steel are the new areas of growth. In a sense, Erode has built on its traditional strengths to emerge as a multifaceted economy. "To start with, plastic industries were set up to supply spares for textile companies. Today we manufacture spares for the automobile sector too, for companies like Hyundai, Tata Motors and TVS Motors," says M. Venkatachalam, managing partner, Jayanthi Plastics. Evidence of a diversifying economy is visible in the north too. Yamunanagar is no longer a one-business town. Besides hosting biggies like Ballarpur Industries and Saraswati Sugar Mills, it is emerging as a major centre for plywood production. With new projects like the 600 MW Reliance Energy thermal power plant, this town is evolving into a commercial hub.

Ditto with Patiala. Located in Punjab's farm-rich Malwa region, it has been in the fast lane of development since 2000. While agriculture remains the mainstay of the economy, the emergence of the service sector and the presence of a mélange of institutions, including two universities, the Thapar Institute of Engineering and Technology, two

52 per cent of households in Rewari earn more than Rs 2.25 lakh per annum.